

The Modern Standard

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No, Tech Start-ups Aren't Taking Over the World

Looking at business news and stock market coverage over the past decade (including a few HBR articles), you'd think that just about every traditional old-economy company has fallen prey – or will soon – to tech-focused competitors. But London Business School's Julian Birkinshaw says that story of disruption and destruction is overblown. His research into Fortune 500 and Global 500 organizations shows that, despite the rise of a few tech giants like Amazon and Google, many industries haven't been radically remade and that many older incumbents are still standing strong. He outlines the strategies they've used to do so, from fighting back to reinvention. Birkinshaw is the author of the HBR article "How Incumbents Survive and Thrive."

Harvard Business Review

When news breaks of a CEO succession, much of the attention is given to the new leader and how they will change the company. But new research shows that the leave-taking process of the outgoing chief executive is often mishandled, with negative impacts on succession and the organization. Rebecca Slan Jerusalem, an executive director at Russell Reynolds Associates, and Navio Kwok, a leadership advisor at RRA, say that boards are often surprised when a CEO gives notice, and they often make that person feel excluded during the handoff process. The researchers share stories from the front lines about CEO psychology, best practices for outgoing leaders and their boards, and broader lessons for effective transitions. Jerusalem and Kwok wrote the HBR article “The Vital Role of the Outgoing CEO.”

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Anne Wojcicki, CEO of 23andMe, spent a decade in healthcare and biotechnology before launching the DNA testing and analysis company in 2006. Her goal was twofold: to help individuals learn more about their own genetics, enabling them to pursue more personalized medical care, and to create a database of genetic information for commercial and academic researchers to promote broader improvements to the healthcare system. She speaks with HBR's Editor-in-Chief Adi Ignatius about tackling challenges in an emerging industry.

Daniel Jonas Roche, The Architect's Newspaper: A new distinction folded into Cooper Hewitt's annual Smithsonian National Design Awards Gala recognizes individual designers, living and deceased, as well as large corporations "for their lasting contributions to the field"

The post Cooper Hewitt to honor Maya Lin, MillerKnoll, Candace Wheeler, and others at its Smithsonian National Design Awards Gala appeared first on The Architect's Newspaper .

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: David Burkus, author of “Under New Management”, explains why some companies are taking extreme measures to limit electronic communication. Burkus is also a professor at Oral Roberts University and host of the podcast Radio Free Leader.

Hadir Al Koshta, ArchDaily: © Alex Shoots Buildings

architects: System Recovery Architects

Location: Strážné, Czechia

Project Year: 2025

Photographs: Alex Shoots Buildings

Photographs: Vítězslav Kuřtka

Area: 293.0 m²

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Jeffrey Garten of Yale School of Management discusses how Genghis Khan, Mayer Amschel Rothschild, Margaret Thatcher, and others made the world more integrated. Garten is the author of “From Silk to Silicon: The Story of Globalization through Ten Extraordinary Lives”.

Christian Allaire, Vogue (runway): The shopping event offered unique vintage designer finds—but the line to get in was its very own street style spectacle.

Miwa Negoro, ArchDaily: © Joon Hwan, Yoon

architects: DRAWING WORKS

Dysfunctional Leadership Teams — and How to Fix Them

Harvard Business Review

CEOs get a ton of credit or blame for a company's performance. But the entire leadership team is vital to success, and any dysfunction is often overlooked. Sometimes the CEOs leading them don't even see that they're not working. Thomas Keil, management professor at the University of Zurich, and Marianna Zangrillo, a partner at The Next Advisors, have interviewed more than 100 CEOs and senior executives. Their research identifies three main types of failing leadership teams: shark tanks, petting zoos, and mediocracies. And they identify the pitfalls of each pattern and how to turn those teams around. Keil and Zangrillo wrote the HBR article "Why Leadership Teams Fail."

Comedian Sarah Cooper On Bringing Humor to Any Career

Harvard Business Review

It's a cliché, but they say it's best to write what you know. That was the case for comedian Sarah Cooper, who rose to viral social media fame in the Trump era through her lip sync TikTok videos. She formerly worked at Yahoo and Google, and she found her way into comedy, in part, by looking at and pointing out the absurdities of corporate culture. She speaks about how humor helped her manage a team, why she took the big risk to quit her job, and how she's navigating the new work world of Hollywood. Cooper is the author of the forthcoming audio book "Let's Catch Up Soon: How I Won Friends and Influenced People Against My Will."

5 Weird & Easy Ways to Water Your Christmas Tree

Heather Fishel · WonderHowTo

Christmas trees, once decorated and brightly lit, are the penultimate holiday decoration, but authentic pines lose their brilliance fast without any nourishment. Plus, they are major fire hazards without regular hydration. But watering one requires a lot of sliding around on the floor, and it can be hard to tell how much water is in the bowl beneath the dark, prickly branches. These five hacks can help! 1. Break Out Your Beer Bong What's better than a tree watering device that requires zero bending and little effort? If you have a beer bong lying around or hiding in your box of old college stuff, pop it in your Christmas tree's stand and create an instant irrigation system.

By placing the end of the beer bong's tubing into the tree stand's bowl, holding the funnel outside of the branches, you can quickly pour in any amount of water and refresh your tree.  2. Use a Funnel for a Quick Irrigation System Happen to have a funnel and some plastic piping in your garage? You're just a few ...more

Stop Initiative Overload

Harvard Business Review

Rose Hollister and Michael Watkins, consultants at Genesis Advisers, argue that many companies today are taking on too many initiatives. Each manager might have their own pet projects they want to focus on, but that trickles down to lower level workers dealing with more projects at a time that they can handle, or do well. This episode also offers practical tips for senior-level leaders to truly prioritize the best initiatives at their company — or risk losing some of their top talent. Hollister and Watkins are the authors of the HBR article "Too Many Projects." with. They are the authors of "Athena Rising: How and Why Men Should Mentor Women."

Dematerialization and What It Means for the Economy — and Climate Change

Harvard Business Review

Andrew McAfee, co-director of the MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, explains how the U. S. economy is growing and actually using less and less stuff to do so. Thanks to new technologies, many advanced economies are reducing their use of timber, metals, fertilizer, and other resources. McAfee says this dematerialization trend is spreading to other parts of the globe. While it's not happening fast enough to stop climate change, he believes it offers some hope for environmental protection when combined with effective public policy. McAfee is the author of the book "More from Less: The Surprising Story of How We Learned to Prosper Using Fewer Resources—and What Happens Next."

Why Burnout Happens — and How Bosses Can Help

Harvard Business Review

Christina Maslach, professor of psychology at the University of California, Berkeley, has been studying the causes of burnout, and its impact, for decades. She says that, in a year when everyone feels overwhelmed and exhausted, it's more important than ever for managers to recognize when and why employees are suffering and take steps to solve those problems. In her framework, burnout stems from not only large workloads but also lack of control, community, and/or reward and values mismatches. She notes that leaders have the ability to pull many of those levers to help their workers. Maslach is the author of "The Truth About Burnout" and a forthcoming book on the topic.

Sad, Mad, Anxious? How to Work Through Your ‘Big Feelings’

Harvard Business Review

When things aren't going well – in our own lives, our community, our country, or the world – it's hard to be productive at work. Most of us also shy away from sharing what we're feeling with colleagues and bosses. But when strong emotions like anxiety, anger, and despair hit you – due to problems at work or outside it – it's important to recognize and thoughtfully address them. Liz Fosslien and Mollie West Duffy are coauthors of the book “Big Feelings: How to Be Okay When Things Are Not Okay,” and they share research-backed advice on how to do just that.

Inside Companies that Get the Purpose-Profit Balance Right

Harvard Business Review

Purpose has become a corporate buzzword over the past decade. Leaders are embracing the idea that companies can't just do well financially; they also have to do good for society. But how many organizations are really walking the talk? Ranjay Gulati, professor at Harvard Business School, has studied how dozens of purpose-driven companies – from Etsy in the United States to Recruit in Japan – simultaneously pursue profits. He argues that while we all want a win-win, leaders must also sometimes learn to make thoughtful tradeoffs. Gulati is the author of the book “Deep Purpose: The Heart and Soul of High-Performance Companies” and the HBR article “The Messy but Essential Pursuit of Purpose.”

The Rise of Corporate Inequality

Harvard Business Review

Stanford economist Nicholas Bloom discusses the research he's conducted showing what's really driving the growth of income inequality: a widening gap between the most successful companies and the rest, across industries. In other words, inequality has less to do with what you do for work, and more to do with which specific company you work for. The rising gap in pay between firms accounts for a large majority of the rise in income inequality overall. Bloom tells us why, and discusses some ways that companies and governments might address it. He's the author of the Harvard Business Review article, “Corporations in the Age of Inequality.” For more, visit hbr.org/inequality.

A Debate Champion on How to Have More Productive Disagreements at Work

Harvard Business Review

In an ideal world, professional conflicts are settled with thoughtful discussion and collaborative decision-making. But that's not usually how it works. More typically, you see leaders – or the loudest voices – win out, leaving others resentful. And sometimes people don't even try to hash out differences of opinion; they'd prefer to avoid a fight. Bo Seo, two-time world champion debater, says we can learn to disagree in healthier, more effective ways that ultimately generate better outcomes for teams, customers, and shareholders. Seo is also the author of the book “Good Arguments: How Debate Teaches us to Listen and Be Heard.”

Applying Porter's Five Forces to Fix U.S. Politics

Harvard Business Review

Katherine Gehl, a former CEO and the founder of the Institute for Political Innovation, and Michael Porter, a professor at Harvard Business School, apply his Five Forces framework to explain why U. S. politics are dysfunctional. They argue that the Republican and Democratic parties make up an industry duopoly with high barriers to entry and low consumer power, and that the resulting lack of competition incentivizes these two dominant players to avoid compromises with majority support. Gehl and Porter provide specific innovations on how to enhance competition and better serve the public, including nonpartisan primary elections and ranked-choice voting. Gehl and Porter are coauthors of the new book “The Politics Industry: How Political Innovation Can Break Partisan Gridlock and Save Our Democracy” and the HBR article “Fixing U. S.

Politics.”

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